

CODEALPHA CYBERSECURITY INTERNSHIP

TASK 2

PHISHING AWARENESS TRAINING

PROJECT REPORT

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1. Introduction

Phishing is a common cybersecurity threat that uses deception and social engineering to influence users into clicking malicious links, disclosing sensitive information, downloading harmful content, or taking other unsafe actions. This project, completed as CodeAlpha Cybersecurity Internship Task 2, developed a phishing awareness training presentation intended to help users recognize suspicious communications and respond safely.

2. Project Objective

The objective was to create a clear, practical, and visually consistent awareness presentation covering phishing concepts, common attack types, social-engineering techniques, warning signs, prevention methods, incident response, a practical scenario, and a short awareness quiz.

3. Tools and Technologies

Microsoft PowerPoint was used to design and organize the 17-slide training presentation. The project combines cybersecurity awareness concepts, fictional phishing examples, structured presentation layouts, and a consistent dark cybersecurity visual theme.

4. Lab / Training Environment

The work is an awareness and education exercise. It does not require a live phishing campaign or interaction with real victims. The examples are fictional and intended to demonstrate warning signs in a controlled training context.

5. Installation and Preparation

The presentation was prepared as a standalone PowerPoint training resource. Preparation involved organizing the learning sequence, creating the slide layouts, adding fictional scenarios, applying the visual theme, and reviewing the finished deck for readability and consistency.

6. Network / Communication Context

Phishing can arrive through multiple communication channels, including email, SMS or messaging applications, and voice calls. The training therefore treats phishing as a human-centered security problem that can occur across different communication paths rather than as an email-only threat.

7. Awareness Training Implementation

The training is structured from basic definition through identification, prevention, response, practical assessment, and conclusion. It introduces phishing, common attack types, social engineering, email and website indicators, smishing and vishing, protection practices, incident response, a practical scenario, a checklist, and a quiz.

8. Content Explanation

The presentation explains concepts in accessible language and uses short examples, warning indicators, checklists, and scenario-based learning. The dark cybersecurity design uses cyan, blue, amber, and red accents to distinguish normal guidance from warnings and high-risk behaviors.

9. Phishing Identification

Users are taught to examine sender addresses, domains, URLs, unexpected requests, urgent language, attachments, login pages, and requests for passwords or one-time authentication codes. The key behavior is to stop and verify rather than respond immediately.

10. Phishing Analysis

The red-flag analysis section demonstrates how a fictional phishing email can combine urgency, generic context, threats of account suspension, and a suspicious verification link. The recommended response is to avoid the link,

verify the request through a trusted route, and report it when appropriate.

11. Practical Scenario

A fictional account-support message is used to test judgment. Learners compare possible actions and identify that independent verification is safer than clicking a suspicious link or replying to an unknown sender.

12. Testing

The completed presentation was reviewed for topic coverage, slide order, readability, formatting consistency, safe use of fictional examples, and logical progression. The final training deck contains 17 slides.

13. Results

The project produced a complete phishing awareness training resource covering recognition, prevention, response, and knowledge checking. The material gives users practical warning signs and actions they can apply when encountering suspicious communications.

14. Screenshots / Evidence

Seven selected figures from the completed training presentation are included in this report to provide visual evidence of the title, phishing concepts, red-flag analysis, fake-website guidance, protection guidance, practical scenario, and awareness quiz.

15. Challenges Encountered

Key development considerations included maintaining a consistent visual design, presenting cybersecurity concepts in accessible language, creating realistic but non-operational examples, and organizing the material into a logical learning sequence.

16. Troubleshooting

The presentation was reviewed for slide formatting, text readability, spacing, font sizing, consistency, and the clarity of the fictional examples. Any presentation issues were addressed through layout and content refinement before finalization.

17. Security Lessons Learned

The project reinforces that cybersecurity depends not only on technical controls but also on informed user behavior. Important lessons include verifying unexpected requests, checking URLs, recognizing social engineering, avoiding impulsive responses to urgent messages, protecting credentials, using multi-factor authentication, and reporting suspicious activity.

18. Conclusion

CodeAlpha Task 2 successfully produced a phishing awareness training resource focused on practical user education. The project provided experience in cybersecurity communication, threat awareness, presentation design, and explaining safe responses to social-engineering threats.

14. Screenshots / Evidence

Seven selected figures from the completed training presentation are included as visual evidence of the final project output.



Figure 1: CodeAlpha Task 2 title slide and project identification.

What Is Phishing?

A social-engineering attack designed to deceive people into unsafe actions.

Definition

Phishing uses deception to imitate a trusted person, company, or service and persuade a victim to take an unsafe action.

What attackers may target

Passwords and login credentials
Financial information
Personal information
MFA / authentication codes
Account or system access

Phishing targets human trust and decision-making.

Figure 2: Introduction to phishing and the types of information attackers may target.

Phishing Email: Red-Flag Analysis

A fictional training example — designed for awareness.

Training email

From: Security Alert <security-alert@example-security.test> Subject: URGENT! Your account will be suspended! Verify your account immediately or your account will be suspended. [VERIFY ACCOUNT]

Urgency

Creates pressure and discourages careful thinking.

Generic context

"Dear User" provides little meaningful context.

Suspicious link

Verify the destination independently before opening.

Correct response: Do not click → Verify independently → Report if suspicious

Figure 3: Fictional phishing email red-flag analysis.

How to Identify a Fake Website

Don't trust appearance alone — verify the address and context.

Check the domain

Look for misspellings, extra words, unusual characters, or misleading domains. Check the full URL before entering credentials.

Verify independently

Use a known bookmark or manually enter the official address. HTTPS encrypts a connection but does not prove legitimacy.

A professional-looking website can still be malicious.

Figure 4: Guidance for identifying suspicious or fake websites.

How to Protect Yourself from Phishing

Build habits that slow down the attacker's social-engineering advantage.

Verify before trusting

Check sender, domain, URL, and context. Don't click unexpected links. Use known bookmarks or trusted channels.

Protect your accounts

Enable MFA. Use unique passwords. Never share OTPs. Keep software updated. Report suspicious activity.

Golden rule: STOP → THINK → VERIFY → REPORT

Figure 5: Recommended practices for protecting against phishing.

Practical Phishing Scenario

Test your judgment before revealing the answer.

Fictional message

From: Account Support <support@example-security.test>
URGENT — Account Verification Required We detected unusual activity. Your account will be suspended today unless you verify your information immediately. [VERIFY NOW]

A — Click it

It looks like a security message.

B — Don't click

Verify the request independently first.

C — Reply

Ask the sender whether it is legitimate.

Correct answer: B — Verify independently.

Figure 6: Practical phishing scenario used to test user judgment.

Phishing Awareness Quiz

Five questions to test the most important concepts.

01-03

What is phishing? Which is a common warning sign?
Does HTTPS guarantee legitimacy? Think about the
warning signs before choosing.

04-05

What should you do with an unexpected OTP request?
What should you do after entering a password into a
phishing site?

Reveal the answers after the audience votes — then explain why.

Figure 7: Phishing awareness quiz used to reinforce learning.

Appendix A — Full 17-Slide Sequence

- 1. Task 2 Title / Phishing Awareness Training
- 2. What Is Phishing?
- 3. Common Types of Phishing Attacks
- 4. Social Engineering Techniques
- 5. How to Identify a Phishing Email
- 6. Phishing Email: Red-Flag Analysis
- 7. How to Identify a Fake Website
- 8. Smishing & Vishing
- 9. How to Protect Yourself from Phishing
- 10. What If You Clicked a Phishing Link?
- 11. Practical Phishing Scenario
- 12. Phishing Red Flags Checklist
- 13. Real-World Impact of Phishing
- 14. Phishing Awareness Quiz
- 15. Key Takeaways
- 16. Conclusion
- 17. Thank You